

EXPERIMENT NO: 5

UX RESEARCH, PROBLEM STATEMENTS AND USER PERSONAS

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AIM

To identify user pain points, formulate UX problem statements, select appropriate user research methods, and create user personas for two different UX project scenarios.

SCENARIO 1: FOOD DELIVERY APPLICATION

1. Introduction

A food delivery mobile app designed to help users discover local restaurants, browse menus, customize meals, track live deliveries, and make digital payments.

2. Identifying User Pain Points

- Inaccurate live delivery tracking causes anxiety and uncertainty.
- Hidden packaging and delivery fees appear only at checkout.
- Lack of clear dietary filters (e.g., pure veg, allergen-free).
- Complex cancellation and refund procedures for wrong orders.

3. UX Problem Statements

- **Problem Statement 1:** Busy professionals need a way to see accurate live tracking updates because estimated delivery times fluctuate unpredictably, which results in missed deliveries and meal delays.
- **Problem Statement 2:** Budget-conscious diners need a way to view all delivery costs upfront because hidden charges appear at the final payment screen, which results in cart abandonment and frustration.

4. Appropriate Research Methods

- **User Interviews:** Talk with everyday app users to uncover emotional frustration with delivery delays and hidden charges.
- **Surveys:** Gather quantitative data from students and office workers on ordering frequency, budget limits, and app preferences.
- **Usability Testing:** Observe users searching for a meal, applying dietary filters, and completing checkout to identify friction.
- **Most Suitable Methods:** User interviews and usability testing, because they reveal both user expectations and direct interface obstacles during checkout.

5. User Personas

Persona 1: Riya

- **Demographics:** Age 21 | College Student | Chennai
- **Goals:** Order affordable food quickly between classes; track delivery arrival accurately.
- **Behaviors:** Uses delivery apps daily; searches for student promo codes; pays via UPI.
- **Pain Points:** High delivery fees on small orders; delayed order updates during peak hours.
- **Motivation:** Wants quick, budget-friendly meals without wasting study or break time.

Persona 2: Suresh

- **Demographics:** Age 38 | Corporate Team Lead | Chennai
- **Goals:** Order healthy, allergen-safe family dinners with minimal browsing effort.
- **Behaviors:** Orders 2–3 times a week; reorders from saved favorites; values punctuality.
- **Pain Points:** Unclear restaurant hygiene ratings; lack of detailed ingredient and allergen info.
- **Motivation:** Wants a reliable, transparent service that delivers correct orders on schedule.

SCENARIO 2: MOVIE AND EVENT BOOKING PLATFORM

1. Introduction

An entertainment booking web and mobile platform for reserving cinema tickets, live concert passes, and local comedy shows with real-time seat selection and instant digital passes.

2. Identifying User Pain Points

- Seat layouts do not clearly show screen distance, pillar obstructions, or accessibility paths.
- Steep convenience fees and hidden charges appear only on the final payment screen.
- Timeouts during peak booking windows cause seat reservation failures and double debits.
- Group booking and split-payment options are completely absent.

3. UX Problem Statements

- *Moviegoers need a way to preview accurate seating angles and screen distances because 2D seating grids lack perspective, which results in poor seat selection and an unsatisfactory theater experience.*
- *Event attendees need a way to view total ticket prices upfront because surprise convenience fees appear at final checkout, which results in abandoned transactions.*

4. Appropriate Research Methods

- **User Interviews:** Discover booking anxieties, group planning frustrations, and payment drop-off triggers.
- **Usability Testing:** Measure time-to-book and user confusion during seat selection on interactive seat maps.
- **Competitor Benchmarking:** Compare checkout steps and fee transparency across major ticketing services.
- **Most Suitable Methods:** Usability testing and user interviews, because booking tickets is a time-sensitive, task-driven flow where checkout clarity is critical.

5. User Personas

Persona 1: Kavya

- **Demographics:** Age 21 | Undergraduate Student | Chennai
- **Goals:** Book weekend cinema tickets for a group of 5 friends with decent view seats within a budget.
- **Behaviors:** Coordinates movie plans over group chats; pays via UPI; books immediately when ticket bookings open.
- **Pain Points:** 8-minute checkout timers cause rush errors; unexpected high booking fees ruin the group budget.
- **Motivation:** Enjoy stress-free weekend outings with friends without payment confusion.

Persona 2: Mohan

- **Demographics:** Age 42 | Operations Consultant | Coimbatore
- **Goals:** Book family cinema seats with easy wheelchair accessibility for elderly parents.
- **Behaviors:** Books 2–3 days in advance; prefers quiet corner seats; values clear theater entry instructions.
- **Pain Points:** Seat maps fail to indicate steps/stairs; no option to cancel or reschedule if plans change.
- **Motivation:** Ensure a comfortable, accessible theater outing for his family.

CONCLUSION

The two UX project scenarios demonstrate how user-centered design begins with understanding user problems and requirements. Problem statements help clearly define user needs, while research methods provide valuable information about user behavior and expectations. User personas represent different types of users and help designers develop solutions that are useful, accessible, and easy to use.

Through the food delivery application and movie and event booking platform scenarios, appropriate research methods and user personas were identified to support better UX design decisions.